



Riley Carol

HIRED PIANIST

You play the carols, and you hear everything.

FOR RILEY CAROL'S EYES ONLY · DO NOT SHARE THIS BOOKLET

WHO YOU ARE

Hired to play carols all evening. The piano sits near the corridor to the workshop, so you've had a view of most of the room.

COSTUME

Easy: Bow tie or velvet, sheet music.

Go all out: lounge-pianist glamour: a velvet jacket or dress, a bow tie or pearls, and a folder of carol sheet music.

PUBLIC RELATIONSHIPS

- **Morgan Ivy:** booked you for the party
- **Alex Snow:** you've met before, through work
- **Taylor Star:** your fellow hired entertainer

WHAT YOU WANT TONIGHT

- Keep the music (and the mood) going
- Hear everything without being noticed
- Keep your side job quiet

THE PARTY

Christmas Eve at Snowbury Lodge. The Frost & Fable Toy Company is having its annual party, and its founder, Nicholas "Nick" Frost, is about to raise his favourite red mug for the 9 o'clock toast. Snow is falling. The road is about to close.

YOUR NIGHT AT A GLANCE

1. Arrive

Read this cover and "Before the game". Put on your name tag.

2. Rounds 1–3

Each round: reveal, ask your questions, do your mini task.

3. Accuse

Fill in a ballot: who, how and why.

4. Awards

Best Detective, Best Costume and Best Liar.



CLUE & CANDLE GAMES

Before the game



You were hired to play carols all evening. The piano sits near the corridor to the workshop.

YOUR SECRET

You're secretly writing a jingle for Snow Toys, Alex's company.

You are innocent

HOW TO USE YOUR BOOKLET

- Read "Before the game" now. Read each round only when Inspector Noel starts it.
- Each round gives you something to reveal, questions to ask and a mini task. Do them all, in any order, while you mingle.
- You may keep your secret until your booklet tells you to reveal it. You may not lie about anything on an evidence card, unless your booklet says otherwise.
- Stuck? Ask someone a question from your list, or go and look at the evidence table.

Playing Riley



Your manner: Dreamy, observant and musical. Hum carols under your breath, take requests and let slip that you notice everything from the piano.

LINES TO TRY

- "Any requests? I know every carol there is."
- "From the piano you can see the whole room."
- "I stopped playing the moment he fell."

IF SOMEONE ACCUSES YOU

- Play it light: "I was at the piano all night. Everyone heard me."

FIRST IMPRESSIONS: WHO SEEMS NERVOUS? WHOSE STORY SOUNDS REHEARSED?

Rounds 1 & 2



Round 1



Read only when Inspector Noel starts Round 1

Play it like this: Mention that you could see most of the room from the piano.

REVEAL OR GOSSIP

- You were playing "Silent Night" at the 9:00 toast, and saw Nick pour something from a little bottle into his mug.
- Gossip: you saw headlights at 7:15 when Alex's taxi pulled up.

QUESTIONS TO ASK

- Ask Charlie which photos were taken near the piano.
- Ask Casey who carried the mug from the kitchen.

MINI TASK

Take carol requests: ask three guests for their favourite carol and what they were doing when Nick collapsed.

Round 2



Read only when Inspector Noel starts Round 2

Play it like this: Admit you know Alex, if asked.

REVEAL OR GOSSIP

- From the piano you can see the door to the workshop corridor.
- Gossip: you've heard Snow Toys pays very well.

QUESTIONS TO ASK

- Ask Alex whether Snow Toys is planning anything big.
- Ask Morgan who has keys to the workshop.

MINI TASK

Find out who left the main room between 9:40 and 9:50.

CONVERSATION TRACKER: TICK EVERYONE YOU'VE QUESTIONED

☐ Robin Holly

☐ Jordan Tinsel

☐ Sam Garland

☐ Casey Sleigh

☐ Alex Snow

☐ Morgan Ivy

☐ Taylor Star

☐ Charlie Bell

☐ Frankie Fir

☐ Quinn Mistletoe

☐ Jamie Pudding

☐ Inspector Noel

Round 3 & notes



Round 3



Read only when Inspector Noel starts Round 3

Play it like this: Share this: at about 9:45, just after Nick collapsed, you heard a window creak open at the workshop end of the corridor, and footsteps hurrying back.

REVEAL OR GOSSIP

- You stopped playing the moment Nick fell, and that's when you heard the window.
- The footsteps came back towards the main room, quickly.

QUESTIONS TO ASK

- Ask Alex what they saw in the corridor.
- Ask who walked back in from the corridor just before 9:50.

MINI TASK

Hum a carol to set the mood as ballots are filled in. Stay in character!

BEFORE YOU VOTE

Look at the evidence table one last time. Your ballot needs who, how and why, plus the clue that convinced you.

NOTES

Suspects at Snowbury Lodge

Robin Holly · Head Toymaker
 Sam Garland · Nick's Nephew or Niece
 Alex Snow · Rival Toymaker
 Taylor Star · Hired Santa
 Frankie Fir · Lodge Gardener
 Jamie Pudding · Village Baker
 Inspector Noel · the host

Jordan Tinsel · Finance Director
 Casey Sleigh · Caterer
 Morgan Ivy · Personal Assistant
 Charlie Bell · Marketing Manager
 Quinn Mistletoe · Journalist
 Riley Carol · Hired Pianist
 Nick Frost · the victim